

MADHYASTH DARSHAN · CO-EXISTENTIALISM

The Epistemology of Coexistence

What must be known, how decisions are governed, and how understanding becomes humane conduct

Based on the revised study (AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org)

Primary texts of Shri A. Nagraj — MVD · KD · SB · JV (tr. Rakesh Gupta) · 1 / 26





Five Parts in Three Movements

- 1 Parts 1–2 — define knowledge, knower, and known; then explain why freedom of action needs direction.
- 2 Parts 3–4 — examine jeevan and bodily mediation; then govern activity, decision, and orderliness.
- 3 Part 5 — test understanding through result, correction, upakar, and transmission.



The Questions This Account Must Answer

- ❓ What is knowledge? — What is its ground and canonical content?
- ❓ Who knows? — What is jeevan's role, and how does the body mediate?
- ❓ Why is knowledge needed? — What directs imagination and freedom of action?
- ❓ What activities must be governed? — Bodily, sensory, social, and higher-human.
- ❓ How are decisions made? — Which perspectives, laws, regulation, and balance apply?
- ❓ What counts as evidence? — How do result, correction, and transmission test a claim?



The Ground Is Knowledge; Jeevan Knows

The omnipresent ground

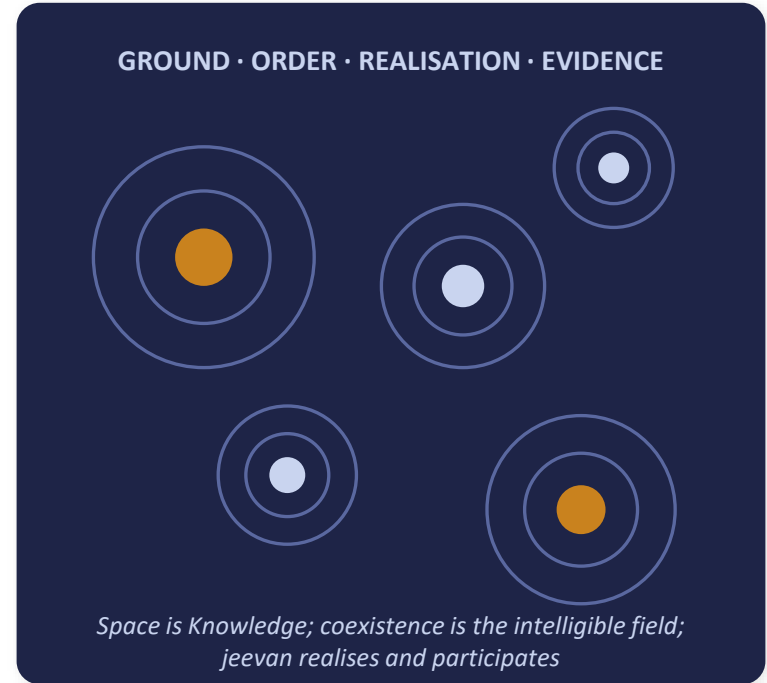
MVD identifies Space or the omnipresent ground as Knowledge: actionless and non-transforming, yet the ground in which units act.

Order evident in coexistence

Law, regulation, balance, justice, dharma, and truth are evident within coexistence. This does not make every unit a thinker.

Realisation and evidence

Jeevan is the knower. Realisation brings the why and how of activity into resolution; humane conduct makes that understanding answerable in life.





What Knowledge Must Make Operable

The canonical content is coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct. In practice, that understanding must guide activities, comparisons, and the order by which action remains mutually fulfilling.



Canonical content

Existence as coexistence; jeevan as the active knower; humane conduct as right recognition and fulfilment.



Fields of activity

Four vishayas; five sensory modalities; samadhan with three eshanas; upakar as higher-human help.



Decision and order

Six evaluative perspectives; niyam, niyantran, santulan; action, result, evaluation, and correction.



§1.1

Knowledge, Knower, and Known



Knowledge

Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct that can guide evaluation and participation.



Knower

Jeevan is the sentient bearer of knowing; the human joint form makes understanding speakable, actionable, and testable.



Known

Coexistence: Space, units, orders, relationships, values, bodily conditions, and humane participation.



Evidence

Resolution, relationship, work, result, correction, upakar, and independent transmission make the claim answerable.

The roles remain distinct: jeevan knows, coexistence is known, and knowledge is the realised relation made effective in life.



Freedom of Action Needs Knowledge

- 1 Humans inherit a body with definite needs, but human conduct is not constitutionally fixed in the same manner.
- 2 Imagination and freedom of action allow incompatible beliefs, alternative choices, institutions, and environmental change.
- 3 Knowledge is needed to align this freedom with coexistence and the human aspiration for happiness.

Without understanding, freedom can amplify contradiction; with understanding, it becomes responsible participation. · MVD pp. 115–116 · JV pp. 61, 165 · 7 / 26



The Human Goal Directs Freedom



Happiness

Harmony between selection and deliberation: what is chosen no longer contradicts the understood purpose.



Peace

Harmony between deliberation and contemplation: reasoning and meaning remain mutually coherent.



Contentment

Harmony between contemplation and enlightened resolve: accepted meaning becomes settled direction.



Bliss

Harmony between resolve and realisation in awakened jeevan.

Resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence name the human goal; happiness, peace, contentment, and bliss name coherence within jeevan.



Knowledge, Wisdom, and Science

Complete understanding must establish what is real, recognise the human goal, and give practicable direction for its accomplishment. The three terms cooperate without becoming interchangeable.



Gyan — knowledge

Realised understanding of coexistence, jeevan, and humane conduct: what is, who knows, and what participation requires.



Vivek — wisdom

Knowledge by which the human goal — resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence — is recognised.



Vigyan — science

Directional knowledge for material prosperity together with the human and jeevan goals, including the law and process of activity and thought.



Delusion or Awakening

The decisive issue is what jeevan takes as the self and which reference points govern sensation, desire, thought, resolve, and action.

Delusion

Jeevan identifies with the body. Only four-and-a-half activities become effective, and deliberation is governed by sensation, health, and profit.

Awakening

Jeevan knows itself and coexistence. The same faculties align around justice, dharma, truth, resolution, and fulfilment of relationship.

The faculties remain active in both conditions; their direction and coordination change. Error is incomplete functioning of the knower, not merely missing information.



The aspiration for happiness remains while sensation-governed conduct repeatedly fails to secure it.



Ten Activities, One Jeevan

The ten activities are five coordinated pairs. Reflection and projection are two directions of the same active jeevan, not separate minds or independent mechanisms.

Five loci and paired activities

- Atma — realisation / authenticity
- Buddhi — enlightenment / resolve
- Chitta — contemplation / visualisation
- Vritti — deliberation / analysis
- Mun — taste / selection



Two recurrent directions

- Reflection examines experience until meaning becomes clear and resolvable. Projection carries realisation outward as selection, action, behaviour, work, communication, and evaluation.

Higher activities orient and integrate those below; bodily expression returns consequences for renewed reflection.



Knowing and Doing Form a Recurrent Cycle

Attention and reflection deepen knowing; realisation and projection place understanding into action, where result and evaluation return material for correction.

Inward movement

Experience and consequence return through attention and reflection until meaning can be understood and resolved.

Outward evidence

Realisation projects as selection, action, behaviour, work, communication, and evaluation in the human joint form.

Neither direction is complete alone: reflection without projection remains unevidenced; projection without reflection repeats habit.



Result and evaluation return projected action to renewed attention.



Jeevan Knows; the Body Mediates

Knowing belongs to jeevan, while human evidence requires the joint form. The body supplies sensory access, brain-mediated signalling, speech, movement, work, and participation with others.

Jeevan — sentient bearer

- Realisation, enlightenment, contemplation, deliberation, selection
- Evaluation of relationship and value
- Continuity of the knower across bodily change



Human joint form — lived evidence

- Brain and senses carry signals and bodily conditions
- Speech and action place understanding in a shared world
- Work, behaviour, and teaching make claims answerable to result

The texts specify a functional relation between jeevan and brain; a more precise account of interaction remains an open explanatory task.



Cognisance Regulates Sensitivity



Cognisance

Knowing and accepting in jeevan; it supplies direction through relationship, value, purpose, and orderliness.



Sensitivity

Embodied responsiveness through the senses. It supplies contact and capacity for action, but not fulfilment by itself.



Higher conformance

Justice, dharma, truth, and the human goal govern deliberation and the use of bodily and material means.



Lower conformance

Pleasantness, health, and gain remain necessary information but cannot finally authorise contradiction or injustice.

Governance, not suppression, is the relation: cognisance directs embodied sensitivity toward right participation.



Four Vishayas, Five Sensory Modalities



Four vishayas — what is served

Eating, sleeping, protection or defence, and mating are bodily propensities retained in the human joint form.



Five modalities — how contact occurs

Sound, touch, visible form, taste, and smell are bodily interfaces through which engagement occurs.



Different questions

The four identify the bodily propensity being served; the five identify the mode of contact and information. They are not nine independent activities.



Samvedana is broader

MVD uses samvedana for sensing and other cognitive-organ meanings; “five sensory modalities” is therefore the more precise label.

Bodily life is regulated for nourishment, protection, continuity, justice, ecology, and right use — not rejected.



Satisfaction Has Three Different Durations

MVD distinguishes temporary sensory satisfaction, longer-lasting intellectual satisfaction, and non-transforming satisfaction in realisation. These are not interchangeable grades of bodily pleasure.



Sensory satisfaction

Temporary satisfaction arising through embodied contact with sound, touch, visible form, taste, and smell.



Intellectual satisfaction

Satisfaction associated with samadhan and the humane fulfilment of the three eshanas in family and society.



Realisation-based satisfaction

Non-transforming restfulness grounded in realisation rather than in a changing sensory or social condition.



Social Motives Need Resolution

Samadhan and the three eshanas belong to the field of intellectual and social satisfaction. Resolution orients each motive as understood responsibility rather than appetite without limit.



Putreshana — progeny

Family and social continuity, education in humaneness, and confidence that the next generation can participate responsibly.



Vitteshana — wealth

Prosperity and right use: wealth acquired with justice and directed toward sufficiency, production, protection, and complementarity.



Lokeshana — public recognition

Recognition in service of undivided society and universal orderliness, not fame or applause as an end.



Upakar Is Higher-Human Participation



Definition

Help and inspiration directed toward another person's material sufficiency and understanding.



Purpose

Prosperity and awakening: the beneficiary becomes more able to meet material needs and understand humane participation.



Boundary

Upakar is not a fourth eshana and not the sole proof of knowledge; it belongs to higher-human activity.



Analytical implication

Because the stated ends are prosperity and awakening, help should increase capability and avoid dependency or exploitation. This is an analytical implication, not a separate quoted definition.

MVD defines upakar as help and inspiration for prosperity and awakening. It is a distinct field of resolved participation, not another bodily propensity, eshana, or social motive.



All Six Inform; the Latter Three Govern

Jeevan compares an intended activity across six perspectives before action. The first three report changing conditions; the latter three judge relationship, orderliness, and accord with coexistence.

Sensory + bodily

*Priya–apriya — pleasant or unpleasant.
Hita–ahita — nourishment, well-being, or harm.*

Material + relational

*Labha–alabha — goods, exchange, gain or loss.
Nyaya–anyaya — right or wrong behaviour in relationship.*

Order + reality

*Dharma–adharma — resolution or contradiction.
Satya–asatya — accord or non-accord with realisation in existence.*

Governing hierarchy

Priya, hita, and labha remain relevant inputs. Nyaya, dharma, and satya govern humane deliberation, so pleasure, health, or gain cannot authorise injustice or contradiction.



Order in Activity Has a Definite Sequence

Knowledge of activity includes its law, the regulation that keeps action within that law, and the balance or complementarity that results. The human sequence continues into justice, dharma, and truth.

Activity triad

Niyam — the law that protects and disciplines an activity.
Niyanttran — regulation according to that law.
Santulan — balance sustained in mutuality.

Human evidence

Law becomes evident in just behaviour; regulated thought supports dharma or resolution; realisation in coexistence accords with truth.

The source gives a functional progression, not three equations: niyam is not simply nyaya, niyantran is not simply dharma, and santulan is not simply satya.



Understanding must connect what the principle is, how activity stays within it, and what balance becomes evident.



Knowledge Governs the Activity Cycle

Before action, jeevan identifies the activity, compares across six perspectives, and understands the relevant law, regulation, and balance. After action, result and evaluation test what was actually fulfilled.

Decision

Ask what activity is proposed; what priya, hita, and labha indicate; and whether nyaya, dharma, and satya authorise it.

Orderliness

Know the niyam, maintain niyantran, seek santulan, and evaluate whether relationship and purpose were mutually fulfilled.

Correct intention is insufficient: capacity, conditions, other people, material consequences, and the wider orders affect the result.



Result and evaluation return material for renewed deliberation and correction.



Knowledge Must Become Publicly Legible

Realisation is first-person, but not private immunity from examination. Knowledge becomes encounterable through behaviour, practical experiment, evaluation, upakar, and independent transmission.

Realisation — first-person

Jeevan directly understands coexistence, itself, and humane conduct; authenticity is the capacity to bear that understanding.

Behaviour — relational

Recognition and fulfilment of values make understanding visible where mutual satisfaction can be assessed.

Experiment — practical

Work and productive participation expose understanding to material conditions, consequences, repeatability, and correction.

Upakar and transmission — social

Help and teaching must increase another's capacity; understanding must become independently liveable and conveyable.



Error Can Persist Despite Information

Error appears where knowing loses contact with reality, self, relationship, activity, or result. Confidence and institutional authority can remain high while the deeper sequence is broken.

Delusion — bhram

Jeevan is identified with the body; sensitivity becomes the governing reference and accepting separates from knowing.

Mystery — rahasyata

Reflection does not reach realisation, or realisation does not project as evidence; faculties remain misaligned.

False learning fails to understand form, property, essential nature, or dharma as it is, producing doubt and over-, under-, or mis-evaluation.

Doubt



Distorted evaluation



Contradiction



Renewed inquiry

Correction requires renewed attention, reflection, action, result, and evaluation — not stronger assertion of the original belief.



Practical Tests and Evidential Limits

- 1 **Test right use — do bodily and material practices support health, prosperity, justice, and ecological complementarity?**
- 2 **Test capability and mutuality — does help increase sufficiency and understanding, and is value-fulfilment mutual?**
- 3 **State the limit — correct intent can meet incapacity, scarcity, refusal, illness, conflict, or mixed results; ontology, conduct, and self-report need independent checks.**



The Questions, Answered

- ❓ What is knowledge? — The omnipresent ground is Knowledge; jeevan realises coexistence, itself, and humane conduct.
- ❓ Why is it needed? — To direct imagination and freedom of action toward the human goal.
- ❓ What activity is governed? — Four vishayas, five sensory modalities, samadhan with three eshanas, and upakar.
- ❓ How are decisions made? — Priya–hita–labha inform; nyaya–dharma–satya govern; niyam–nivantran–santulan organise activity.
- ❓ How is error corrected? — Through action, result, evaluation, renewed reflection, and practical discrimination.
- ❓ What counts as evidence? — Coherence across realisation, relationship, work, mutual fulfilment, upakar, and transmission.

THE CULMINATION · HUMAN GOAL AND JEEVAN VALUES

An Awakened Human Tradition

Knowledge is complete when it governs activity, corrects itself through evidence, and participates consciously in universal orderliness.

Resolution

Happiness

Prosperity

Peace

Fearlessness

Contentment

Coexistence

Bliss

The relation is cumulative: realised understanding becomes right decision, balanced activity, humane conduct, upakar, and transmissible tradition. ·

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